

Catalogers Group Minutes November 18, 2004

Present: Gia Aivazian, Sharon Benamou, Valerie Bross, Beth Feinberg, Hao Phan, Sara Layne, Janice Matthiesen, Renée McBride, Luiz Mendes, Caroline Miller (recorder), Louise Ratliff, John Riemer, Angela Riggio, Barbara Rudich, Rita Stumps

(Thanks to Sara and Valerie for their notes.)

I. Sara Layne reported on the workshop which recently took place at the Getty: Cataloging Cultural Objects – CCO.

A May 2004 preliminary draft is available online <http://www.vraweb.org/CCOweb/> , but it is not the same version as recently published by ALA.

Sara attended this workshop as a representative of ALCTS at the request of Brian Schottlaender.

Lanzi, Elisa. “Cataloging Cultural Objects: new guidelines for descriptive cataloguing” *Art Libraries Journal* 29/4 (2004): 26-32.

Visual objects primarily

Data elements sets

- VRA Core (Visual Resources Association)

- CDWA (Categories for the Description of Works of Art)

No ‘content standard’ or descriptive cataloging code; CCO is essentially a cataloging code for visual materials.

Patricia Harpring: CCO is more prescriptive, less comprehensive than CDWA; CCO is not an element set; it is a set of recommendations

All the usual reasons for having a standard ...

- Well-supported applications—vendors and database design

- More useful federated search results

- Less ‘original’ cataloging

- Standards support data exchange

The “public good” of cataloging

Bringing together image community, museum community, library community, archival community

CCO and AACR; complementary codes (we hope)

CCO may be used for collection-level descriptions
CCO right now aimed at English-speaking groups, but Latin America, Germany, Sweden
all interested

CCO addresses the question of “what are you cataloging?” and talks about works and
relationships
CCO addresses all kinds of access (including subject)
CCO addresses authority control, indexing, and display, as well as what we libraries call
‘description’
CCO addresses issues of uncertainty (sort of the way latest serial rules address change)

Matthew Beacom: interface, database, metadata—three separate decisions often made in
isolation—need to be talking to each other—hope that CCO will “bring the threads
together”

What now or what next ...

Outreach and training; prototypes (Getty db, XML records into EnCompass)

**II. Valerie Bross reported on the workshop:
New Government Information Landscape: UC Opportunities for Shared Collections
and Collaboration. This workshop was sponsored by SOPAG and took place in
Oakland on Oct. 28, 2004.**

This workshop was organized by Marilyn Moody (UCSB), Kris Kasianovitz, and Patricia
Cruse (CDL) at the request of SOPAG (Systemwide Operations and Planning Advisory
Group).

Background

Signaling the perceived significance of the workshop, the UCLA participants met with Gary
Strong and Bob Bellanti both before and after the workshop. At the pre-workshop meeting,
we learned that this workshop had its inception in the Final Report (May 2003) of the
SOPAG Task Force on Government Information. Of the 15 recommendations from that
Report, the ULs approved three:

1. Develop Shared Collections of Government Information, housed at the Regional
Library Facilities, upon which campuses can rely for permanent retention in order to
make local decisions on the retention of materials. Material to be stored should focus
initially on significant runs of serial materials and large sets of low use.
2. The Task Force recommends the establishment of a small steering committee to
implement the Shared Collection. The committee should be empowered to work
directly with SOPAG, to seek advice and assistance from the All Campus Groups,
and to consult with interested parties such as the UC/Stanford Government
Information Librarians.
3. Begin with existing RLF collections as the core of the Shared Collections.

SOPAG decided to authorize an informational Workshop first, and then consider establishing a task force on shared documents collections.

Workshop

New Government Information Landscape was held Oct. 28 at Preservation Park in Oakland. One of the highlights was definitely the locale--a city block of renovated Victorian homes in downtown Oakland. Both before the workshop and during the lunch break, we enjoyed strolling around the homes.

The workshop was split into two parts. In the morning, we heard from six speakers in quick succession: Dan Greenstein, Judith C. Russell (Superintendent of Documents), Janet Coles (senior librarian at the California State Library), Lucia Snowhill (UCSB Government Documents Librarian), Nancy Kushigian (Director of Shared Print), Patricia Cruse (CDL). In the afternoon, we broke into small discussion groups to identify chief concerns and to respond to questions listed on a handout. Each group had one of the following topics:

- Retaining Government information expertise throughout the UC system
- Training and communication (activities to enhance librarians' ability to use government information)
- Shared collections
- Preservation issues (both digital & tangible formats)

Highlights

- Dan Greenstein: Emphasized the importance of shared collection development to assist in building high-end research collections
- Judith Russell: Noted that although 86% of federal documents are online, there remains 14% print-only—one third of which are maps. In an attempt to look innovatively at funding strategies, GPO is negotiating to move to smaller quarters and rent the land. Regarding the depository program: GPO realizes that the most important aspect is the expertise developed by librarians in the program.
- Janet Coles: Announced that the State Library has joined OCLC and is in the process of loading 1.2 million records
- Patricia Cruse: Provided a brief overview of the National Digital Information Infrastructure and Preservation Program (NDIIP) Web-at-Risk partnership between CDL and U of North Texas/NYU. The Partnership will be exploring 4 paths of activities. First, the partners will select targeted collections; second, the partners will examine or develop open source tools for preservation, analysis, data capture, registry maintenance, archive auditing, and user support. Third, the project will develop preservation repositories. Finally, the project offers an opportunity to explore organizational agreements, business planning, and sustainability. The project will begin January 2005.

Postmortem

On Nov. 8, Gary Strong, Bob Bellanti, and the participants met to talk about the workshop. Kris K. was in the process of tabulating the notes given her by the discussion groups and the evaluation forms; she expects the ideas to be available on the SOPAG

web site around mid-December. Among those from UCLA, a few themes were of special interest: shared collections (and what that would mean for SRLF); training faculty/students to use government information effectively (e.g., Kris K's work with Social Welfare doctoral students); shared cataloging and how it relates to the HOTS issue of redefining Melvyl.

Questions: Given the ULs interest, we may expect future sessions at UCLA focusing on government documents. Doubtless some of the same issues will come up then as came up during the workshop staffing expertise, shared collections, digital repositories, and so forth. Interestingly, the workshop was mainly focused on public services; and I wondered what perspectives catalogers would bring to these topics. So, I've gathered a few questions that came up for discussion, to hear your thoughts:

1. Training/staffing: Are there any special considerations that come to mind, re cataloging documents?
2. Shared collections: What concerns would you have about cataloging shared collections? Receiving records for shared collections cataloged at other campuses?
3. Planning role: How should UCLA/UC catalogers be participating in the planning activities related to documents: To changes in the federal depository program? To the document repository projects?

(Handout)
New Government Information Landscape
October 28, Oakland

Purpose

- To bring together librarians from various functional areas
- To share information related to federal and state documents
- To gather ideas related to training & communication, retaining expertise (with shrinking staffs), shared collections, and preservation issues

Organizers

- Marilyn Moody (UCSB)
- Kris Kasianovitz
- Patricia Cruse (CDL)

Speakers

- Dan Greenstein (CDL University Librarian and Executive Director)
- Judith C. Russell (GPO Superintendent of Documents)
- Janet Coles (Senior Librarian at the California State Library)
- Lucia Snowhill (UCSB Government Documents Librarian)
- Nancy Kushigian (UC Director of Shared Print)
- Patricia Cruse (CDL, Director, Digital Preservation)

Related Links

1. New economic models for the federal depository system--why is it so hard to get the question answered?, *The Journal of Academic Librarianship*. Volume 30, Issue 3 , May 2004, Pages 243-249, by John A. Shuler. <<http://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/B6W50-4C62BC8-1/1/3dd7d3ce3e0e30efffb97fa88c007f2b>>
2. "Future Directions of the Depository Library Program" -- Judy Russell's address to ARL directors. <<http://www.arl.org/arl/proceedings/142/russell.html>>
3. Keeping America Informed in the 21st Century: A First Look at the GPO Strategic Planning Process -- A Work in Progress (PDF) by Bruce R. James, Public Printer of the United States <http://www.access.gpo.gov/su_docs/fdlp/pubs/proceedings/James.DLC.04192004.revised.pdf>
4. Remarks of Superintendent of Documents Judith C. Russell (PDF) by Judith C. Russell, Managing Director, Information Dissemination (Superintendent of Documents) http://www.gpoaccess.gov/about/speeches/04182004_DLC.pdf
5. CyberCemetery: <http://govinfo.library.unt.edu/default.html> (web sites for defunct U.S. government agencies)